

- HACKATHON PROBLEM STATEMENTS

Four problems worth solving, from the field to the boardroom.

A working set of challenges pulled from real operational friction across *finance, compliance, project delivery, and customer experience*, scoped for a single build cycle.

● PROBLEM 01

Project financial management & reporting platform

Project estimating, cost tracking, forecasting, purchase order management, change order tracking, and management reporting are currently spread across disconnected tools, spreadsheets, and enterprise systems. Estimates aren't developed in consistent formats, and reporting requires manual consolidation from separate sources. This makes it difficult to compare project costs, reuse historical estimate data, track performance, or deliver timely reporting.

Layered onto this, existing forecast reports are generated from exported financial results and are brittle: when companies, projects, or underlying business logic change, reports break and require manual rework. A durable solution needs a reporting layer flexible enough to produce reliable output from raw exported data without a rebuild every time something upstream shifts.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Build a centralized platform that standardizes estimate development, retains historical estimates for benchmarking, maps costs to a consistent work breakdown structure (WBS), and supports budgets, actuals, forecasts, purchase orders, commitments, and change orders. It should include dashboards, trend analysis, variance reporting, and exportable views for leadership and project teams that keep working as the underlying data changes.

● Finance & cost management

● Reporting resilience

● Dashboards & forecasting

● PROBLEM 02

Compliance procedure automation

Compliance teams create numerous facility-specific procedures from the same governing standards. Producing each one by hand is repetitive and slow, and it's prone to drift: small inconsistencies compound across facilities, creating audit risk and uneven documentation quality even when every procedure is meant to trace back to the same source standard.

What's needed is a way to start from a single master procedure and apply facility-specific inputs from approved sources, generating consistent, customized compliance documentation on demand, with controlled, auditable handling of the source data throughout.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Build a solution that ingests a master procedure and facility-specific inputs from approved sources, then generates accurate, on-brand, facility-ready compliance documentation, with clear provenance for every piece of source data used and consistent output no matter which facility it's built for.

● Compliance & governance

● Document generation

● Controlled data handling

● PROBLEM 03

LiDAR data availability for transmission route development

Transmission route development often requires aerial LiDAR collection over potential study areas. This process can be costly and deadline-driven, and it depends on seasonal conditions that affect data quality. In many cases, usable LiDAR data already exists across public sources or previously acquired datasets, but there's no easy way to see what's already available for a given study area before committing to a new, expensive collection effort.

Without centralized visibility, teams risk duplicating collection that's already been done elsewhere, or discovering usable data too late in a tight route-development window to take advantage of it.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Build a solution that identifies existing LiDAR coverage across public and previously-acquired sources, centralizes visibility into what's available for a study area, and helps teams reduce duplicate collection and minimize new data acquisition during tight route development timelines.

● Geospatial data

● Transmission route planning

● Data cataloging

● PROBLEM 04

Interconnection customer self-service portal

Interconnection customers currently navigate a process that relies heavily on emails, manual updates, disconnected systems, and project-manager-driven communications. This creates unnecessary complexity, limited visibility into project status, inconsistent customer experiences, and a growing administrative burden on internal teams as interconnection volume scales.

Customers are left waiting on status updates instead of being able to check them, and internal teams spend time relaying information that could be self-served.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Build a single digital customer portal that provides transparency, self-service access, document management, milestone tracking, task management, and real-time project visibility. The result should be faster project execution, improved customer engagement, and interconnection operations that scale without scaling headcount.

● Customer experience

● Self-service portal

● Interconnection operations

Judging criteria

100 points across five categories, plus up to 15 bonus points.



Clarity of concept

20 pts

Does the app clearly communicate its purpose and who it's for?

SCORE	DESCRIPTION
17–20	The app's purpose is immediately obvious; target audience is clear; no explanation needed.
12–16	Mostly clear, with minor confusion about scope or audience.
7–11	Requires significant explanation; concept is vague or unfocused.
0–6	Purpose is unclear, or the app doesn't address the theme.



UX & visual design

20 pts

Is the app intuitive, polished, and enjoyable to use?

SCORE	DESCRIPTION
17–20	Clean, professional design; intuitive navigation; interactive elements are responsive and smooth.
12–16	Functional and readable, with minor UX friction or visual inconsistencies.
7–11	Usable but rough; layout issues or confusing interactions.
0–6	Difficult to navigate; aesthetics significantly detract from the experience.



Technical execution

20 pts

How well was the app built? Does it actually work?

SCORE	DESCRIPTION
17–20	Fully functional; no major bugs; interactive features (toggles, sliders, charts) work as intended.
12–16	Core functionality works, with minor bugs or incomplete features.
7–11	Partially working; some features broken or unresponsive.
0–6	Major functionality missing or non-functional.

Judging criteria, continued



Creativity & wow factor

20 pts

Did the team bring something fresh, unexpected, or impressive to the theme?

SCORE	DESCRIPTION
17–20	Surprising angle or feature; genuinely memorable; judges talk about it after.
12–16	Solid creative approach that goes beyond the obvious.
7–11	Competent but expected execution, with limited creative risk.
0–6	Minimal creativity; basic execution of the most literal interpretation.



Presentation & demo

20 pts

Can the team sell it? Is the demo compelling and within time?

SCORE	DESCRIPTION
17–20	Confident delivery; tells a clear story; demo flows smoothly; handles Q&A well.
12–16	Good delivery with minor stumbles; story is mostly clear; demo works.
7–11	Presentation is disorganized, or the demo has issues; story is hard to follow.
0–6	No real narrative; demo fails or doesn't run; team is unprepared.



Bonus categories

Up to +15 pts, not to exceed 100 total.

BONUS	POINTS	DESCRIPTION
NEET insider	Up to +5	App uses real NEET-specific data, terminology, or scenarios.
Most useful in real life	Up to +5	Judges agree this could be deployed for actual use within a week.
Improving the application	Up to +5	Clear path forward toward improving the application post-deployment.

Maximum possible score: **100 points** (five categories at 20 points each), plus up to **15 bonus points**, capped at 100 total.

● READY TO BUILD

Pick a problem. Ship something real.

Teams may choose any one of the four problem statements above as the basis for their hackathon build. Judging will weigh clarity of the solution, feasibility within the build window, and how directly the outcome addresses the stated opportunity.